

file. Most images go to a resource folder called `drawable`. There'll be three folders with this name in your Package Explorer:

- /res/drawable-hdpi for high-density screens
- /res/drawable-mdpi for medium-density screens
- /res/drawable-ldpi for low-density screens

Create a folder called `drawable` in the `res` folder by selecting `New > Folder` by right-clicking `res` menu. Add your pictures independent of screen density in this folder with the name `background.jpg`. Although Android supports many formats, it's advisable to use PNG as it is lossless when compared to GIF.

Now we'll have a reference to `R.drawable.background`, created by ADT plug-in of Eclipse. We could use this from Java; instead we'll update the status activity layout file `res/layout/status.xml`. Now, we have two ways of adding the background to the top layout.

3.9.2 Using WYSIWYG Editor

Select the main layout. A highlighted border indicates the selected layout. Open the outline element and select the top element there (or from `Window > Show View > Outline`). Select the top layout from the Outline view, and you'll notice a border around the entire activity. Next, open the Properties view in Eclipse (`Window > Show View > Other`), and under the General section, pick Properties. In this view, you can change various properties. To modify the background, click on the `"..."` button which will open the Reference Chooser dialog. Choose `Drawable > Background`, which will set the background of the top layout to `@drawable/background`. Our `status.xml` layout is referring to the `background.jpg` drawable.

3.9.3 Updating directly in XML Code

Open the `status.xml` in the XML editor. To add the background resource to the entire activity, add `android:background="@drawable/background"` to the `<LinearLayout>` element.

3.9.4 Adding Color

You can customize the color of backgrounds from the standard RGB color set, or optionally expand it with an Alpha channel. Color can be expressed as RGB or ARGB, where A is the amount of transparency, R is the amount of red, G is for green, and B stands for blue. The combination of these three colors along with the optional transparency gives you the entire spectrum of colors. Each channel can be represented as values between 0 and 255,